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	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Document Receipt Form	REC Form No.	**26**
		Version No.	**09-00**
		Effective Date:	**08/01/25**

IMPORTANT:
The purpose of this checklist is to provide support for USC REC Secretariat conducting screening of submission materials.

Protocol Code:					
Protocol Title:				**Ver.**	
Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):					
Contact No. of Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):					
Email of Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):					
Type of Submission:		Initial Submission		Study Completion Report and Final Paper	
		Resubmission for re-review		Continuing Review of Approved Protocols	
		Protocol Amendments		Protocol Termination	
		Others: <*please specify*>			
Institution:					

Checklist to assess the projects before they are submitted to USC REC				
Item No.	**Mandatory Documents**	**Yes**	**No**	**NA**
1	Cover Letter			
2	USC REC F-27 - Research Protocol Application Form, duly filled and signed by the Researcher(s)/Proponent(s)			
3	USC REC F-28 - Data Privacy Consent Form			
4	USC REC F-29 - Capsule Proposal Template			
5	Research Proposal/Study protocol			
6	Informed Consent Form (ICFs) in English and/or, *if applicable,* dialect spoken and understood by research participant(s)			
7	Assent Form for minors (*if applicable*) in English and/or dialect spoken and understood by research participant(s)			
8	Research instrument (if applicable)			
9	Request approval for the use of research instrument(s) (*if applicable*)			
10	Signed and dated brief current Curriculum Vitae (CV) of Researcher(s)/Proponent(s)			

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Document Receipt Form	REC Form No.	**26**
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Checklist to assess the projects before they are submitted to USC REC				
Item No.	**Mandatory Documents**	**Yes**	**No**	**NA**
11	Signed and dated brief current Curriculum Vitae (CV) of Adviser			
12	USC REC F-30 - Detailed Budget Sheet			
13	USC REC processing fee			
14	Amendments, if any			
15	Any other documents submitted			

Remarks			
Received by:	*< Signature above printed name of USC REC Staff>*	**Date:**	

INSTRUCTIONS:
For protocols with multiple researchers/proponents, the designated project leader must be listed first in the roster of names

APPLICATION DETAILS			
Date of Submission to USC REC:			
Protocol Code:			
Protocol Title:		**Ver.**	
Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):			
Contact No. of Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):			
Email of Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):			
Institution:			
Institution Address:			

Research Type					
	Clinical Trial (Sponsored)		Social / Behavioral Research		Stem Cell Research
	Clinical Trials (Researcher-initiated)		Public Health / Epidemiologic Research		Genetic Research
	Health Operations Research (Health Programs and Policies)		Biomedical research (Retrospective, Prospective and diagnostic studies)		Others: *<please specify>*

Approximate Duration of the Study in months:	
Expected number of participant(s):	
Study Site:	

Source(s) of Funds:			
	Researcher-funded		Agency other than institution: _____
	Institution-funded: _____		Others: _____

Declaration(s) by the Researcher(s)/Proponent(s): *(please tick the items below)*		
	I am aware of the ethical aspects of this research project.	
	I hereby grant my express consent to USC REC, its officer/s, its member/s, independent consultant/s, and all person/s involved in the conduct of the review of my/our protocol and anything related to it, such as but not limited to: collection, use, share, storage, protection, and access of all types of personal information.	
	I commit and submit the Continuing Review Approval Form on an annual basis to the University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee (USC REC).	
	I will ensure that changes in approved research protocols are reported promptly and are not initiated without approval by the USC REC, except when necessary to eliminate apparent immediate hazards to the participant(s).	
	I will ensure that all adverse or unforeseen problems arising from the research project are reported in a timely fashion to the USC REC.	
	I will provide notification when the study is complete and if it fails to start or is abandoned.	
Conflict of Interest (COI) *(please tick the appropriate item):*		
	I hereby declare that I have no actual or potential conflict of interest in this protocol	
	I hereby declare that I have either an actual or potential conflict of interest in this protocol, please specify the COI here: _____	
Signature of Proponents/ Researchers:		**Date:**

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION, CONTACT:

USC REC SECRETARIAT
University of San Carlos, Nasipit, Talamban, Cebu City
(032) 401 2300 loc. 204
Email: rec@usc.edu.ph

Protocol Code:			
Protocol Title:		**Ver.**	
Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):			

General Privacy Statement

The University of San Carlos (USC) values and understands the importance of protecting the privacy of personal information and the confidentiality of data, information and knowledge and is committed to the responsible handling of such. This Privacy Policy Statement explains what information will be gathered and the details how collected information is used without breaching its privacy and confidentiality.

Scope

This Privacy Policy Statement applies to personal information about applicants, prospective applicants, students and employees maintained, used, processed and/or kept in custody by the University of San Carlos.

Types of personal information:

- Personal information: Recorded information about a living identifiable or easily identifiable individual
- Sensitive information: Personal information about a living individual's race or ethnicity, political opinions, religious or philosophical beliefs, sexual preferences or practices, criminal record, or membership details, such as trade union or professional, political or trade associations, genetic data and biometric data.
- Medical information: Information about a living or deceased individual's physical, mental or psychological health.

1. Information that we collect

USC collects the following information:

- Personal Information: name, residential address, email address, telephone number, date of birth, passport details (for international applicants) and nationality. USC will also assign you with a unique applicant/student identification number once you apply or is accepted in the University;

- Education background employment history: the school(s) and/or universities you have attended, programs and course that have been completed, date(s) of completion, and the institution(s) where it was completed. For applicants for employment, we will also keep records of your work history, evaluation of your previous work, your past employers and other related service information;
- Information about your family or personal affiliations, and academic and extracurricular interests since these maybe relevant to the assessment of your suitability to receive scholarships/student financial aids/assistance;
- Sensitive personal information such as your political affiliations, sexual preferences or practices, criminal record, or memberships details, religious or philosophical beliefs and ethnicity among others;
- Information concerning your health/medical conditions including your medical history, diagnosis of illness(es), disability and dietary needs.

2. How we collect your information

USC may collect your personal data in several ways:

- From the information you provide to the University when you contact us and you express your interest in studying at the University of San Carlos;
- When you apply to study at USC and complete application forms/enrollment forms and when you complete other admissions procedures;
- When you make inquiries, or communicate with us via email, through our University accounts in various social media platforms (Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, Youtube);
- Through other ways by which you interact us during your time as a student, employee, donor, or third party of USC, for example from your previous school, university or employers who may provide a reference about you.

3. From whom do we collect information

USC collects information only from the following:

- prospective and current students
- exchange students
- visiting and exchange professors
- job applicants
- existing employees
- alumni
- donors (individual/company)
- research participants
- industry partners
- university contractors, suppliers, concessionaires
- partner civic organization volunteers

- other members of the public who interacts and has transactions with the university

4. How we use your information

USC uses personal and sensitive personal information as we perform and fulfill our core functions which includes teaching, research and community extension. We use your information according to the primary purpose for which it was collected and for other related purposes as required by law and with your consent. We will not share the information with third parties unless you give your written consent or there is an order from the court. We may use and process your information for:

- Educational support: admission, enrolment, assessment/testing, learning activities, graduation, content delivery and learning activities, graduation, student services such as counselling, library use, medical examination and data analysis;
- Research: data analysis, commercialization and administration;
- Community extension and industry engagement: alumni relations, industry partnerships, website operation, event invitations and community forum;
- Employment: recruitment, payroll processing, employee development and other human resource programs and activities, annual physical examination;
- Operational/infrastructure management: processing fees, data analysis, financial management, IT, legal and professional services, and educational opportunities, CCTV monitoring, access to systems, identity management and emergency response;
- Non-academic matters in support of our core services, including: provision of student support services, managing student accommodation, parking within the campus, dealing with grievances and disciplinary actions;
- For other purposes permitted by law, such as the provision of information to government agencies and legal entities.

5. To whom we share your information

USC may share your personal data with certain third parties if called for by official business or transaction and in consonance with the provisions of the Data Privacy Act. We may disclose limited personal data to a variety of recipients including:

- Our employees and administrators;
- Third parties who have legitimate transactions with the University such as: agencies who work with us to provide health care and insurance, scholarship sponsors, current/potential education providers, funding bodies, current/potential employers for references, professional regulatory bodies with regards to the confirmation of qualifications, registration for professional examination/certification, government agencies where we have a legal obligation to provide information, third parties conducting researches and surveys. These recipients of the above-mentioned organizations and third party service providers are required to keep personal

information confidential and provide the same privacy safeguards as we do in the University.

6. How we store and protect your information

USC takes appropriate security measures to protect your personal information from loss, and unauthorized access or disclosure.

- Stored information is archived in accordance with the ICT Policy of the University which determines when information should be retained or disposed. Proper actions are taken into consideration to destroy and disposes personal information when it is no longer needed.
- Upon request, information will be destroyed unless applicable law requires destruction after the expiration of an applicable retention period. The manner of destruction shall be appropriate to preserve and ensure the confidentiality of your information given the level of sensitivity, value and criticality to the University.
- Personal information may be stored as hard/printed copies, as electronic data, in the University's Integrated School Management Information System and other application systems in the network or its designated repositories.

7. Rights and Access to Information

USC honors the rights of data subjects with regards to access of stored personal information and to request its correction, update or deletion in applicable circumstances. You may request access to your personal information and in some instances, you will be able to access and update your personal information yourself through the Integrated School Management Information System portal. You may also access or correct your personal information by directly contacting the area specific unit of the University that holds your information such as the Office of the Registrar and the Information Resource Management Office among others.
Where applicable you may be allowed the following (provided it is legal to do so):
Rectify personal information held about you where it is incorrect or incomplete (right to rectification)

- Request that your personal information be deleted if certain legal grounds are met (right to erasure)
- Rectify personal information held about you where it is incorrect or incomplete (right to rectification)
- Restrict or object to how your personal information is used (right to object and restrict processing); and
- Obtain a copy of your data in a commonly used electronic form, or request us in writing that we share your personal information with any person acting on your behalf (such as agents, guardians, employers, government departments) (right to portability).

8. Review

The Board of Trustees shall review this policy every two (2) years, and may amend the same at any time if deemed necessary.

9. Effectivity

This Policy shall take effect upon its adoption by the Board of Trustees (ADOPTED - 11th day of May 2019).

Consent

I/we have fully read this form, fully understood all its contents, and hereby give my/our full and express consent to the collection, processing, and/or storage of my/our personal information/data.

I/we fully understand that I/we have data privacy rights which include the following: right to be informed, right to access, right to object, right to erasure or blocking, right to damages, right to file a complaint, right to rectify, and right to data portability.

Name of researcher(s)/proponent(s)	Signature(s)	Date
1.		
2.		

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Capsule Proposal	REC Form No.	29
		Version No.	09-00
		Effective Date:	08/01/25

INSTRUCTION: In accomplishing this form, make sure to indicate all the elements listed per section where applicable.

Protocol Code:			
Protocol Title:		**Ver.**	
Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):			

INTRODUCTION

In this section, provide a description and significance of the problem/phenomenon studied, review theory and empirical work and problem statement, more specifically:
1. **Scientific background/context** inclusive of summary of the **literature review** that presents the current knowledge in one paragraph
<Type your entry for this section here.>
2. **Rationale/Significance** that identifies the **gaps and/or limitations in the literature** and how your study may be able to address these gaps/limitations along with potential utility of generated information and its potential users;
<Type your entry for this section here.>
3. **Research question(s)/general objective(s)**
<Type your entry for this section here.>
4. **Sub-question(s)/specific objective(s)** of the study in bullet form
<Type your entry for this section here.>
5. **Justification** for the need to involve human participant(s)
<Type your entry for this section here.>

OPERATIONAL DEFINITIONS

List/Enumerate and define study outcomes. Make sure that the definitions are anchored in measuring the specific variables in the study.
<Type your entry for this section here.>

METHODOLOGY

Make sure to provide the following points:
1. **Research/Study design** – Whether quantitative, qualitative (e.g. ethnography, grounded

theory, case study, phenomenology, narrative research) or a combination and guiding theory if appropriate along with the research paradigm (e.g. postpositivist, constructivist/ interpretivist)
<Type your entry for this section here.>
2. **Research setting/environment.** In no more than 3 sentences, describe and justify the selection of the study site(s) in relation with the safety, convenience privacy and confidentiality considerations for the participant(s) and researcher(s)/proponent(s)
<Type your entry for this section here.>
3. **Study population** (in not more than 5 sentences, state the number and relevant characteristics of participant(s), documents, or events included in the study)
<Type your entry for this section here.>
4. **Inclusion criteria.** Attributes that when met, make an individual a potential participant(s) of your study including participant(s)' age range with justification
<Type your entry for this section here.>
5. **Exclusion criteria.** State the condition(s) why potential participant(s) must be excluded despite qualifying in the inclusion criteria
<Type your entry for this section here.>
6. **Sampling procedure.** Detailed steps in recruiting study participant(s) or selecting documents/events (includes consent-seeking before participant's decision whether to participate or not)
<Type your entry for this section here.>
7. a one-paragraph statement about the **pre-data gathering** coordinative actions to be taken with potential participant(s), organization(s), etc. (includes transmittal letters, invitation letters, call for participation posters/posts)
<Type your entry for this section here.>
8. **Sampling design/strategy.** A one-paragraph specification of your sampling strategy and how it will be executed in terms of gathering or recruiting participant(s)
<Type your entry for this section here.>
9. **Sample size**: Provide a one-paragraph statement indicating the sample size and how your study's sample size is computed with justification for its suitability; indicate separate sample size for mixed methods design, if applicable
<Type your entry for this section here.>
10. **Data collection tools, technologies and techniques**: In 2-3 sentences, describe the instruments (e.g. interview guides, questionnaires) and devices (e.g. audio recorders, video camera)

to be used for data collection including the main content/theme of the questionnaire(s)/data collection tool(s), its domains and type of questions, e.g. open- or close-ended
<Type your entry for this section here.>
11. Identification of original source/developer of questionnaire/interview instrument/data collection tool(s) if not developed by the researcher(s), and permission to use the scale
<Type your entry for this section here.>
12. Description of **validation/pre-testing procedure** for the data collection tool(s) including contextual presentation for participant(s)' comprehension, e.g. (back-) translation of questionnaire(s), certificate that qualitative questions were checked by experts, content validation certificate, reliability testing results (for quantitative scales)
<Type your entry for this section here.>
13. Brief but sufficient description of the **conduct of survey/interview** including its duration of answering the survey/doing the interview, start and end dates of data collection and analysis as well as details of the collection of accomplished questionnaires/data collection tool(s), iterative process, triangulation of sources/methods, and modification of procedures in response to evolving study findings, with justification
<Type your entry for this section here.>

DATA ANALYSIS PLAN

Describe the analytical treatment of data such as: 1. Identification of which descriptive statistical techniques will be used (e.g. measures of central tendency and dispersion, use of tables or graphs), whether the study is descriptive or analytical. 2. The process by which inferences, themes, etc. will be identified and developed in relation with the research paradigm/approach. 3. Techniques intended to assure the reliability of data analysis, where applicable, e.g. audit trail, triangulation. 4. If quantitative, state statistical test/software to be used, or level of significance if inferential statistics is used, i.e. if the study is intended to use the results obtained from the participant(s) to estimate the true information to the general population. 5. Include also a statement of data processing methods before and during analysis such as transcription, data entry and data management.
<Type your entry for this section here.>

ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

The section's goal is to ensure that in designing and conducting the study, the rights of the participant(s) are being upheld and protected.

State how ethical soundness in the conduct of the study will be upheld, to wit:

1. Disclosing actual or potential conflict(s) of interest and/or collaborative study terms of reference if applicable, e.g. multi-country/multi-institutional studies.
2. Obtaining ethics clearance and other applicable approvals;
3. Securing participant(s) consent and administering a debriefing where applicable, or explanation for its non-applicability;
4. Ensuring participants' safety and convenience, privacy (e.g. anonymization/deidentification), confidentiality in the responses;
5. Adopting measures that adequately address data protection issues in the acquisition, use, transfer, processing, storage and disposal of collected data, e.g. data coding, encryption, electronic and hardware storage and treatment of evolving study findings and disposal.

<Type your entry for this section here.>

Researcher(s) (Add/Delete rows as needed and indicate appendix number/s of dated and signed CVs.)

Full Name of Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s)	Designation/ Course & Yr. & Institution	Email Address	Signature	Appendix No.

RESEARCH SUPERVISOR'S/ADVISER'S/MENTOR'S' VERIFICATION (Indicate appendix number/s of dated and signed CVs.)	Appendix No.
SIGNATURE: _____ **FULL NAME:** _____ **DESIGNATION:** _____ **UNIT/DEPT.:** _____ **INSTITUTION:** _____ **EMAIL ADDRESS:** _____	

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Detailed Budget Sheet	REC Form No.	30
		Version No.	09-00
		Effective Date:	08/01/25

Protocol Code:			
Protocol Title:		**Ver.**	
Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):			

Particulars	**Sources of Funds and Amount (PhP)**			
	Personal	**External Source***	**Internal Source***	**TOTAL**
I. Personnel Services (PS)				
a. Salaries				
b. Honoraria				
<details>				
Sub-total for PS				
II. Maintenance and Other Operating Expenses (MOOE)				
a. Traveling expenses				
<details>				
b. Supplies and materials expenses				
<details>				
c. Incentive for the respondent				
<details>				
d. Ethics Review Fee				
Sub-total for MOOE				
III. Capital Outlay				
Sub-total for Capital Outlay				
IV. Administrative Cost				
GRAND TOTAL				

**External Source – outside your affiliated institution;*
Internal Source – affiliated institution

Protocol Code:			
Protocol Title:		**Ver.**	
Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):			

Type of Submission			
✔	Initial Submission		Application for Continuing Review
	Protocol Amendment Application		Protocol Deviation/ Violations
	Study Completion Report Form		Early Termination Reports
	Appeal		SAE/SUSAR Report
	Others: *(Please specify)*		
Risk to Study Participants			
	Below minimal risk		Minimal risk*
	Greater than minimal risk		No risk
**A risk is minimal when the probability and magnitude of harm or discomfort anticipated in the proposed research are not greater, in and of themselves, than those ordinarily encountered in daily life or during the performance of routine physical or psychological examinations or tests (National Ethical Guidelines for Health Research 2011, p. 150)*			
Can the Study Protocol be Exempt from Review?			
	YES		NO
If yes, fill out Checklist for Exemption from Ethical Review (F-41)			
If NO, Type of Review			
	Expedited Review		Full Review
Justification			
Designated Reviewers:			
Scientist:			
Non-Scientist:			
Accomplished by:			
Signature over Printed Name *Date*			

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Protocol Review Assessment Form	REC Form No.	35
		Version No.	09-00
		Effective Date:	08/01/25

INSTRUCTIONS:

TO THE RESEARCHER(S) /PROPONENT(S):	Please indicate in the space provided below whether or not the specified assessment point is addressed by your study protocol. To facilitate the evaluation of the assessment point, indicate the page and paragraph where this information can be found or "NA" if not applicable.
TO THE PRIMARY REVIEWER(S):	Please evaluate how the assessment points outlined below have been appropriately addressed by the study protocol, as applicable by confirming the submitted information and putting your comments in the space provided. Indicate your conclusions under "RECOMMENDED ACTION" and sign on space provided.

Protocol Code:			
Protocol Title:		**Ver.**	
Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):			
Date:	**<mm/dd/yyyy>** [*to be filled-up by reviewer*]		

ASSESSMENT POINTS		**Page and paragraph number where assessment point can be found**	**REVIEWER'S ASSESSMENT**		
			Yes, No, Unable to assess	**Detailed Comments/ Observations**	**Specific Recommendations**
1.	**SCIENTIFIC VALIDITY**				
1.01.	Is/Are the main research question(s) reasonable?				
1.02.	Are the study objectives specific, measurable, attainable, and reasonable based on the research instrument(s) presented?				
1.03.	Is/Are the research instrument(s)/data collection tool(s)				

ASSESSMENT POINTS		Page and paragraph number where assessment point can be found	REVIEWER'S ASSESSMENT		
			Yes, No, Unable to assess	Detailed Comments/ Observations	Specific Recommendations
	adopted from existing one(s) and has the developer's consent for its usage in the study?				
1.04.	Does the protocol present sufficient background information or results of previous studies that merit the involvement of human participants?				
2.	**ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS IN THE CONDUCT OF STUDY**				
2.01.	In conducting this research, is there no conflict of interest on the part of the researchers and/or their Research Adviser(s)/Supervisor(s)/Mentor(s)?				
2.02.	For faculty-initiated research only: Is there disclosure of collaborative study terms of reference (e.g. multi-country/ multi-institutional studies, including intellectual property rights, publication rights, information and responsibility in sharing, transparency and capacity building)?				
2.03.	Is/Are the researcher(s) sufficiently				

ASSESSMENT POINTS		Page and paragraph number where assessment point can be found	REVIEWER'S ASSESSMENT		
			Yes, No, Unable to assess	Detailed Comments/ Observations	Specific Recommendations
	knowledgeable/ trained to conduct the proposed study based on his/her/their dated and signed CV?				
2.04.	Do(es) the Research Adviser(s)/Supervisor(s)/Mentor(s) has/have sufficient research experience based on his/her/their dated and signed CV?				
2.05.	Is the research environment/site/facility appropriate?				
2.06.	Does the selection and recruitment of participants comply with the ethical demands of equity?				
2.07.	Is the duration of human participants' involvement in the study reasonable?				
2.08.	Does the study involve individuals who are vulnerable, i.e. those whose pertinent circumstances will likely impair their capacity to give free, prior and informed consent?				
2.09.	Are appropriate mechanisms in place to protect the potential vulnerable participants,				

ASSESSMENT POINTS		Page and paragraph number where assessment point can be found	REVIEWER'S ASSESSMENT		
			Yes, No, Unable to assess	Detailed Comments/ Observations	Specific Recommendations
	e.g. assent form for children?				
2.10.	Are probable risks/harm to the human participants as result of participation in the study clearly identified, i.e. physical, psychological, social, economic, legal?				
2.11.	In order to adequately address the risk/benefit balance, does the protocol provide means/mechanisms that sufficiently mitigate the risks/probable harm to the human participants?				
2.12.	Is the informed consent procedure/form adequate and culturally appropriate, e.g. (back-) translation is appended? Indicate "NA" if not applicable.				
3.	**DATA PROTECTION PLAN**				
3.01.	Does the study involve personal/sensitive data collection and/or processing?				
3.02.	Does the protocol provide measures for personal/sensitive information to be				

ASSESSMENT POINTS		Page and paragraph number where assessment point can be found	REVIEWER'S ASSESSMENT		
			Yes, No, Unable to assess	Detailed Comments/ Observations	Specific Recommendations
	sufficiently anonymized for adequate data protection?				
3.03.	Is there legal permission to obtain and process the data? Indicate "NA" if not applicable.				
3.04.	Does the study specify how long collected data will be used/processed?				
3.05.	Does the protocol provide measures as to how data transfer/sharing information will be monitored?				
3.06.	Does the study discuss how and where collected data will be securely stored in terms of data structure/format or encryption of identifiable information and separation from sensitive data such as health data?				
3.07.	Does the study discuss how and where collected data will be securely stored in terms of treating unforeseen data added				

ASSESSMENT POINTS		Page and paragraph number where assessment point can be found	REVIEWER'S ASSESSMENT		
			Yes, No, Unable to assess	Detailed Comments/ Observations	Specific Recommendations
	such as incidental findings during the study?				
3.08.	Does the study discuss where collected data will be securely stored in terms of location and hardware, e.g. avoids loss/easily accessible media such as memory sticks?				
3.09.	Does the protocol indicate how collected data will be securely accessed?				
3.10.	Does the study clearly state how and when collected data will be (ir)reversibly disposed/destroyed?				
4.	**Do you have any other concerns?**				

RECOMMENDED ACTION:

☐	APPROVED
☐	MINOR MODIFICATIONS REQUIRED
☐	MAJOR MODIFICATIONS REQUIRED
☐	DISAPPROVED
JUSTIFICATION:	

PRIMARY REVIEWER:

_____ _____

Signature over printed name Date

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Informed Consent Form Assessment Checklist	REC Form No.	36
		Version No.	09-00
		Effective Date:	08/01/25

INSTRUCTIONS:

TO THE RESEARCHER(S) /PROPONENT(S):	Please indicate in the space provided below whether or not the specified assessment point is addressed by your study protocol. To facilitate the evaluation of the assessment point, indicate the page and paragraph where this information can be found or "NA" if not applicable.
TO THE PRIMARY REVIEWER(S):	Please evaluate how the assessment points outlined below have been appropriately addressed by the study protocol, as applicable by confirming the submitted information and putting your comments in the space provided. Indicate your conclusions under "RECOMMENDED ACTION" and sign on space provided.

Protocol Code:			
Protocol Title:		**Ver.**	
Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):			
Date:	**<mm/dd/yyyy>** [*to be filled-up by reviewer*]		

ASSESSMENT POINTS		**REVIEWER'S ASSESSMENT**		
		Yes, No, Unable to assess	**Detailed Comments/ Observations**	**Specific Recommendations**
1. Is it necessary to seek the informed consent of the participant(s)?				
If NO, are specific exemptions under duly recognized guidelines invoked in the study/research proposal according to the contextual conditions?				
For Researcher(s)/Proponent(s):	**Please indicate, in the shaded area, the page and paragraph number where assessment point can be found.**			
If YES, are the participants provided with sufficient information about:				
1.01.	Purpose of the study?			
1.02.	Institutional affiliation of the researcher(s), research sponsor(s)/research funder(s)?			
1.03.	Expected duration of the participation in the study?			
1.04.	Procedures to be carried out?			

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Informed Consent Form Assessment Checklist	REC Form No.	**36**
		Version No.	**09-00**
		Effective Date:	**08/01/25**

ASSESSMENT POINTS			REVIEWER'S ASSESSMENT		
			Yes, No, Unable to assess	**Detailed Comments/ Observations**	**Specific Recommendations**
1.05.	Study aspects that are experimental?				
1.06.	Discomforts and inconveniences?				
1.07.	Risks (including possible discrimination)?				
1.08.	Random assignment to the trial use/treatments? (if applicable)				
1.09.	Reimbursement as a result of participation in the research (travel costs and/or time lost)?				
1.10.	Benefits to the participants?				
1.11.	Benefits to the community/ society/ stakeholders, or contributions to scientific knowledge?				
1.12.	Alternative procedures/treatments? (if applicable)				
1.13.	Compensation and/or medical treatments in case of injury?				
1.14.	Person(s) and contact particulars to contact for further information regarding the study and who to contact in the event of research-related injury?				
1.15.	Statement that the study has undergone ethics review by the Research Ethics Committee and may be reached regarding rights of study participants, including grievances and complaints through the contact information below? < name of USC REC Chair > Chair, Research Ethics Committee				

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Informed Consent Form Assessment Checklist	REC Form No.	**36**
		Version No.	**09-00**
		Effective Date:	**08/01/25**

ASSESSMENT POINTS			REVIEWER'S ASSESSMENT		
			Yes, No, Unable to assess	**Detailed Comments/ Observations**	**Specific Recommendations**
	University of San Carlos Nasipit, Talamban, Cebu City Email: rec@usc.edu.ph Tel: (032) 4012300 local 204				
1.16.	Foreseeable circumstances and reasons under which participation in the study may be terminated?				
1.17.	Whether or not refusal to participate or discontinuance at any time will involve penalty or loss of benefits to which the subject is entitled?				
1.18.	Extent of confidentiality?				
2.	**Is the informed consent written or presented in non-technical language that participants can understand?**				
3.	**Does the protocol include an adequate process for ensuring that consent is voluntary?**				
4.	**Do you have any other concerns?**				

RECOMMENDED ACTION:

☐	APPROVED
☐	MINOR MODIFICATIONS REQUIRED
☐	MAJOR MODIFICATIONS REQUIRED
☐	DISAPPROVED
JUSTIFICATION:	

PRIMARY REVIEWER:

_____ _____

Signature over printed name Date

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Summary of Reviewers' Comments	REC Form No.	37
		Version No.	09-00
		Effective Date:	08/01/25

This form shall be prepared by the USC REC Reviewers.			
Protocol Code:			
Protocol Title:		**Ver.**	
Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):			
Type of Review:			
Form Contents Reviewed by:	**<signature above printed name>** **Panel Chair**		
Date reviewed:			

NOTE TO RESEARCHER(S)/PROPONENT(S): *USC REC recommendations for revisions are highlighted in yellow.*

PROTOCOL REVIEW ASSESSMENT FORM		
ASSESSMENT POINTS	**PANEL/ REVIEWERS' COMMENTS/ OBSERVATIONS**	**PANEL / REVIEWERS' RECOMMENDATIONS**
1. SCIENTIFIC VALIDITY		
1.01. Is/Are the main research question(s) reasonable?		
1.02. Are the study objectives specific, measurable, attainable, and reasonable based on the research instrument(s) presented?		
1.03. Is/Are the research instrument(s)/data collection tool(s) adopted from existing one(s) and has the developer's consent for its usage in the study?		
1.04. Does the protocol present sufficient background information or results of previous studies that merit the involvement of human participants?		
2. ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS IN THE CONDUCT OF STUDY		

PROTOCOL REVIEW ASSESSMENT FORM			
ASSESSMENT POINTS		**PANEL/ REVIEWERS' COMMENTS/ OBSERVATIONS**	**PANEL / REVIEWERS' RECOMMENDATIONS**
2.01.	In conducting this research, is there a conflict of interest on the part of the researchers and/or their Research Adviser(s)/Supervisor(s)/Mentor(s)?		
2.02.	For faculty-initiated research only: Is there disclosure of collaborative study terms of reference *(e.g. multi-country/ multi-institutional studies, including intellectual property rights, publication rights, information and responsibility in sharing, transparency and capacity building)*?		
2.03.	Is/Are the researcher(s) sufficiently knowledgeable/trained to conduct the proposed study based on his/her/their dated and signed CV?		
2.04.	Do(es) the Research Adviser(s)/Supervisor(s)/Mentor(s) has/have sufficient research experience based on his/her/their dated and signed CV?		
2.05.	Is the research environment/site/facility appropriate?		
20.6.	Does the selection and recruitment of participants comply with the ethical demands of equity?		
2.07.	Is the duration of human participants' involvement in the study reasonable?		
2.08.	Does the study involve individuals who are vulnerable, i.e. those whose pertinent circumstances will likely impair their capacity to give free, prior and informed consent?		
2.09.	Are appropriate mechanisms in place to protect the potential vulnerable participants, e.g. assent form for children?		
2.10.	Are probable risks/harm to the human participants as result of participation in		

PROTOCOL REVIEW ASSESSMENT FORM			
	ASSESSMENT POINTS	**PANEL/ REVIEWERS' COMMENTS/ OBSERVATIONS**	**PANEL / REVIEWERS' RECOMMENDATIONS**
	the study clearly identified, i.e. physical, psychological, social, economic, legal?		
2.11.	In order to adequately address the risk/benefit balance, does the protocol provide means/mechanisms that sufficiently mitigate the risks/probable harm to the human participants?		
2.12.	Is the informed consent procedure/form adequate and culturally appropriate, e.g. (back-) translation is appended? Indicate "NA" if not applicable.		
3. DATA PROTECTION PLAN			
3.01.	Does the study involve personal/sensitive data collection and/or processing?		
3.02.	Does the protocol provide measures for personal/sensitive information to be sufficiently anonymized for adequate data protection?		
3.03.	Is there legal permission to obtain and process the data? Indicate "NA" if not applicable.		
3.04.	Does the study specify how long collected data will be used/processed?		
3.05.	Does the protocol provide measures as to how data transfer/sharing information will be monitored?		
3.06.	Does the study discuss how and where collected data will be securely stored in terms of data structure/format or encryption of identifiable information and separation from sensitive data such as health data?		
3.07.	Does the study discuss how and where collected data will be securely stored in terms of treating unforeseen data added such as incidental findings during the study?		

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Summary of Reviewers' Comments	REC Form No.	37
		Version No.	09-00
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PROTOCOL REVIEW ASSESSMENT FORM			
ASSESSMENT POINTS		**PANEL/ REVIEWERS' COMMENTS/ OBSERVATIONS**	**PANEL / REVIEWERS' RECOMMENDATIONS**
3.08.	Does the study discuss where collected data will be securely stored in terms of location and hardware, e.g. avoids loss/easily accessible media such as memory sticks?		
3.09.	Does the protocol indicate how collected data will be securely accessed?		
3.10.	Does the study clearly state how and when collected data will be (ir)reversibly disposed/destroyed?		
4. Do you have any other concerns?			
RECOMMENDED ACTION:			
JUSTIFICATION FOR RECOMMENDATION:			

INFORMED CONSENT FORM (ICF) CHECKLIST			
ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS		**PANEL/ REVIEWERS' COMMENTS/ OBSERVATIONS**	**PANEL/ REVIEWERS' RECOMMENDATIONS**
1.	Is it necessary to seek the informed consent of the participants?		
If NO, are specific exemptions under duly recognized guidelines invoked in the study/research proposal according to the contextual conditions?			
If YES, are the participants provided with sufficient information about:			
1.01.	Purpose of the study?		
1.02.	Institutional affiliation of the researcher(s), research sponsor(s)/research funder(s)?		
1.03.	Expected duration of the participation in the study?		
1.04.	Procedures to be carried out?		
10.5.	Study aspects that are experimental?		
1.06.	Discomforts and inconveniences?		
1.07.	Risks (including possible discrimination)?		

INFORMED CONSENT FORM (ICF) CHECKLIST			
ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS		**PANEL/ REVIEWERS' COMMENTS/ OBSERVATIONS**	**PANEL/ REVIEWERS' RECOMMENDATIONS**
1.08.	Random assignment to the trial use/treatments? *(if applicable)*		
1.09.	Reimbursement as a result of participation in the research (travel costs and/or time lost)?		
1.10.	Benefits to the participants?		
1.11.	Benefits to the community/society/stakeholders, or contributions to scientific knowledge?		
1.12.	Alternative procedures/treatments? *(if applicable)*		
1.13.	Compensation and/or medical treatments in case of injury?		
1.14.	Person(s) and contact particulars to contact for further information regarding the study and who to contact in the event of research-related injury?		
1.15.	Statement that the study has undergone ethics review by the Research Ethics Committee and may be reached regarding rights of study participants, including grievances and complaints through the contact information below? [Name of REC Chair] Chair, Research Ethics Committee University of San Carlos Nasipit, Talamban, Cebu City Email: rec@usc.edu.ph Tel: (032) 2300100 local 204		
1.16.	Foreseeable circumstances and reasons under which participation in the study may be terminated?		
1.17.	Whether or not refusal to participate or discontinuance at any time will involve penalty or loss of benefits to which the subject is entitled?		

INFORMED CONSENT FORM (ICF) CHECKLIST		
ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS	**PANEL/ REVIEWERS' COMMENTS/ OBSERVATIONS**	**PANEL/ REVIEWERS' RECOMMENDATIONS**
1.18. Extent of confidentiality?		
2. Is the informed consent written or presented in non-technical language that participants can understand?		
3. Does the protocol include an adequate process for ensuring that consent is voluntary?		
4. Do you have any other concerns?		
RECOMMENDED ACTION:		
JUSTIFICATION FOR RECOMMENDATION:		

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Summary of Actions Taken	REC Form No.	38
		Version No.	09-00
		Effective Date:	08/01/25

This form shall be prepared by the USC REC Reviewers.			
Protocol Code:			
Protocol Title:		**Ver.**	*version #/<Date of revision> e.g., 2/28May2022*
Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):			
Type of Review:			
Form Contents Reviewed by:	*<signature above printed name>* **Panel Chair**		
Date Reviewed:			

Accomplished by:	*<signature above printed name>* **Researcher(s)/Proponent(s)**
Date Accomplished:	
Actions Taken Reviewed by:	*<signature above printed name>* **Adviser**

SUMMARY OF ACTIONS TAKEN ON THE STUDY PROTOCOL				
ASSESSMENT POINTS	**Panel/ Reviewers' Comments/ Observations**	**Panel/ Reviewers' Recommendations**	**Actions Taken** *(To Include Page and Paragraph Number) to be filled by the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)*	**Panel/ Reviewers' Remarks**
1. SCIENTIFIC VALIDITY				
1.01. Is/Are the main research question(s) reasonable?				
1.02. Are the study objectives specific, measurable, attainable, and reasonable based on the research				

SUMMARY OF ACTIONS TAKEN ON THE STUDY PROTOCOL				
ASSESSMENT POINTS	**Panel/ Reviewers' Comments/ Observations**	**Panel/ Reviewers' Recommendations**	**Actions Taken** *(To Include Page and Paragraph Number) to be filled by the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)*	**Panel/ Reviewers' Remarks**
instrument(s) presented?				
1.03. Is/Are the research instrument(s)/data collection tool(s) adopted from existing one(s) and has the developer's consent for its usage in the study?				
1.04. Does the protocol present sufficient background information or results of previous studies that merit the involvement of human participants?				
2. ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS IN THE CONDUCT OF STUDY				
2.01. In conducting this research, is there a conflict of interest on the part of the researchers and/or their Research Adviser(s)/Supervisor(s)/Mentor(s)?				
2.02. <u>For faculty-initiated research only</u>: Is there disclosure of collaborative study terms of reference *(e.g. multi-country/ multi-institutional studies, including intellectual property*				

SUMMARY OF ACTIONS TAKEN ON THE STUDY PROTOCOL				
ASSESSMENT POINTS	**Panel/ Reviewers' Comments/ Observations**	**Panel/ Reviewers' Recommendations**	**Actions Taken** *(To Include Page and Paragraph Number) to be filled by the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)*	**Panel/ Reviewers' Remarks**
rights, publication rights, information and responsibility in sharing, transparency and capacity building)?				
2.03. Is/Are the researcher(s) sufficiently knowledgeable/ trained to conduct the proposed study based on his/her/their dated and signed CV?				
2.04. Do(es) the Research Adviser(s)/Supervisor(s)/Mentor(s) has/have sufficient research experience based on his/her/their dated and signed CV?				
2.05. Is the research environment/site/facility appropriate?				
2.06. Does the selection and recruitment of participants comply with the ethical demands of equity?				
2.07. Is the duration of human participants' involvement in the study reasonable?				
2.08. Does the study involve individuals				

SUMMARY OF ACTIONS TAKEN ON THE STUDY PROTOCOL				
ASSESSMENT POINTS	**Panel/ Reviewers' Comments/ Observations**	**Panel/ Reviewers' Recommendations**	**Actions Taken** *(To Include Page and Paragraph Number) to be filled by the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)*	**Panel/ Reviewers' Remarks**
who are vulnerable, i.e. those whose pertinent circumstances will likely impair their capacity to give free, prior and informed consent?				
2.09. Are appropriate mechanisms in place to protect the potential vulnerable participants, e.g. assent form for children?				
2.10. Are probable risks/harm to the human participants as result of participation in the study clearly identified, i.e. physical, psychological, social, economic, legal?				
2.11. In order to adequately address the risk/benefit balance, does the protocol provide means/mechanisms that sufficiently mitigate the risks/probable harm to the human participants?				

SUMMARY OF ACTIONS TAKEN ON THE STUDY PROTOCOL				
ASSESSMENT POINTS	**Panel/ Reviewers' Comments/ Observations**	**Panel/ Reviewers' Recommendations**	**Actions Taken** *(To Include Page and Paragraph Number) to be filled by the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)*	**Panel/ Reviewers' Remarks**
2.12. Is the informed consent procedure/form adequate and culturally appropriate, e.g. (back-) translation is appended? Indicate "NA" if not applicable.				
3. DATA PROTECTION PLAN				
3.01. Does the study involve personal/sensitive data collection and/or processing?				
3.02. Does the protocol provide measures for personal/sensitive information to be sufficiently anonymized for adequate data protection?				
3.03. Is there legal permission to obtain and process the data? Indicate "NA" if not applicable.				
3.04. Does the study specify how long collected data will be used/processed?				
3.05. Does the protocol provide measures as to how data				

SUMMARY OF ACTIONS TAKEN ON THE STUDY PROTOCOL				
ASSESSMENT POINTS	**Panel/ Reviewers' Comments/ Observations**	**Panel/ Reviewers' Recommendations**	**Actions Taken** *(To Include Page and Paragraph Number) to be filled by the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)*	**Panel/ Reviewers' Remarks**
transfer/sharing information will be monitored?				
3.06. Does the study discuss how and where collected data will be securely stored in terms of data structure/format or encryption of identifiable information and separation from sensitive data such as health data?				
3.07. Does the study discuss how and where collected data will be securely stored in terms of treating unforeseen data added such as incidental findings during the study?				
3.08. Does the study discuss where collected data will be securely stored in terms of location and hardware, e.g. avoids loss/easily accessible media such as memory sticks?				
3.09. Does the protocol indicate how				

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Summary of Actions Taken	REC Form No.	38
		Version No.	09-00
		Effective Date:	08/01/25

SUMMARY OF ACTIONS TAKEN ON THE STUDY PROTOCOL				
ASSESSMENT POINTS	**Panel/ Reviewers' Comments/ Observations**	**Panel/ Reviewers' Recommendations**	**Actions Taken** *(To Include Page and Paragraph Number) to be filled by the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)*	**Panel/ Reviewers' Remarks**
collected data will be securely accessed?				
3.10. Does the study clearly state how and when collected data will be (ir)reversibly disposed/destroyed?				
4. Do you have any other concerns?				
RECOMMENDED ACTION:				
JUSTIFICATION FOR RECOMMENDATION:				

SUMMARY OF ACTIONS TAKEN ON THE INFORMED CONSENT FORM (ICF)				
ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS	**Panel/ Reviewers' Comments/ Observations**	**Panel/ Reviewers' Recommendations**	**Actions Taken** *(To Include Page and Paragraph Number) to be filled by the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)*	**Panel/ Reviewers' Remarks**
1. Is it necessary to seek the informed consent of the participants?				
If NO, are specific exemptions under duly recognized guidelines invoked in the study/research proposal according to the contextual conditions?				
If YES, are the participants provided with sufficient information about:				
1.01. Purpose of the study?				
1.02. Institutional affiliation of the researcher(s), research				

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Summary of Actions Taken	REC Form No.	38
		Version No.	09-00
		Effective Date:	08/01/25

SUMMARY OF ACTIONS TAKEN ON THE INFORMED CONSENT FORM (ICF)				
ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS	**Panel/ Reviewers' Comments/ Observations**	**Panel/ Reviewers' Recommendations**	**Actions Taken** *(To Include Page and Paragraph Number) to be filled by the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)*	**Panel/ Reviewers' Remarks**
sponsor(s)/research funder(s)?				
1.03. Expected duration of the participation in the study?				
1.04. Procedures to be carried out?				
1.05. Study aspects that are experimental?				
1.06. Discomforts and inconveniences?				
1.07. Risks (including possible discrimination)?				
1.08. Random assignment to the trial use/treatments? *(if applicable)*				
1.09. Reimbursement as a result of participation in the research (travel costs and/or time lost)?				
1.10. Benefits to the participants?				
1.11. Benefits to the community/society/stakeholders, or contributions to scientific knowledge?				
1.12. Alternative procedures/treatments? *(if applicable)*				
1.13. Compensation and/or medical treatments in case of injury?				
1.14. Person(s) and contact particulars to contact for further information regarding the study and who				

SUMMARY OF ACTIONS TAKEN ON THE INFORMED CONSENT FORM (ICF)					
	ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS	**Panel/ Reviewers' Comments/ Observations**	**Panel/ Reviewers' Recommendations**	**Actions Taken** *(To Include Page and Paragraph Number) to be filled by the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)*	**Panel/ Reviewers' Remarks**
	to contact in the event of research-related injury?				
1.15.	Statement that the study has undergone ethics review by the Research Ethics Committee and may be reached regarding rights of study participants, including grievances and complaints through the contact information below? **[Name of REC Chair]** Chair, Research Ethics Committee University of San Carlos Nasipit, Talamban, Cebu City Email: rec@usc.edu.ph Tel: (032) 401 2300 local 204				
1.16.	Foreseeable circumstances and reasons under which participation in the study may be terminated?				
1.17.	Whether or not refusal to participate or discontinuance at any time will involve penalty or loss of benefits to which the subject is entitled?				
1.18.	Extent of confidentiality?				
2.	Is the informed consent written or presented in				

SUMMARY OF ACTIONS TAKEN ON THE INFORMED CONSENT FORM (ICF)				
ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS	**Panel/ Reviewers' Comments/ Observations**	**Panel/ Reviewers' Recommendations**	**Actions Taken** *(To Include Page and Paragraph Number) to be filled by the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)*	**Panel/ Reviewers' Remarks**
non-technical language that participants can understand?				
3. Does the protocol include an adequate process for ensuring that consent is voluntary?				
4. Do you have any other concerns?				
RECOMMENDED ACTION:				
JUSTIFICATION FOR RECOMMENDATION:				

Protocol Code:			
Protocol Title:		**Ver.**	
Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s):			
Date of Review:	*(For expedited, refer to submission of review; for full review, refer to REC meeting)*		
Type of Review:		Full	
		Expedited	
Type of Submission:		Initial Submission	
		Resubmission	
Documents under review:	1) Protocol Review Assessment Form 2) Study Protocol version ___ 3) Informed Consent Form Checklist 4) Informed Assent/Consent Form for respondents version ___ 5) Curriculum Vitae.		
Decision			APPROVED
			MINOR MODIFICATIONS REQUIRED
			MAJOR MODIFICATIONS REQUIRED
			DISAPPROVED

- **For Protocols that are <u>Approved</u>:**

Appropriate certification will be attached to this notification. Please read the certification thoroughly.

- **For Protocols that need <u>Modifications (Major/Minor)</u>:**

Approval will be granted upon compliance with the REC's recommendations. Kindly revise the study protocol, highlighting all changes, and submit the updated version by [submission deadline]. Additionally, please complete the *USC REC F-38 - Summary of Actions Taken* form in Word format, clearly indicating the actions taken (not just page numbers). Ensure the version number and date of revision appear both in the filename and page footer of the protocol.

Please note that failure to submit the revised protocol within **<u>30 working days</u>** from the receipt of this email will require you to reapply for ethics review. If you need an extension on the submission deadline, please submit a formal letter of request to the Panel Chair within the given revision period.

- **For Protocols that are <u>Disapproved</u>:**

<copy Justification in the PRAF and ICF USC REC F-37 Summary of Reviewers' Comments>

_____

< Signature over printed name >
USC Panel Chair

_____
Date

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Checklist for Exemption from Ethical Review	REC Form No.	41
		Version No.	09-00
		Effective Date:	08/01/25

Protocol Code	:		
Protocol Title	:		Ver.
Researcher(s)/ Proponent(s)	:		

INSTRUCTIONS

To the Panel Chair: Please evaluate how the exemption criteria outlined below apply to the study protocol by confirming the submitted information and putting your comments in the space provided under "COMMENTS." Finalize your review by indicating your conclusions under "RECOMMENDED ACTION" and signing in space provided for the primary reviewer.

	To be filled out by the Panel Chair		
CRITERIA FOR EXEMPTION	Indicate if the assessment point applies to the study protocol		**COMMENTS**
1. PROTOCOL ASSESSMENT	**YES**	**NO**	
1.1. Does this research involve human participants?			
1.2. Does this research involve use of non-identifiable human tissue/ biological samples?			
1.3. Does this research involve use of non-identifiable publicly available data? **Protocols that neither involve human participants, nor identifiable human tissue, biological samples and data shall be exempted from review (NEGRIHP, 2022)*			
1.4. Does this research involve interaction with human participants?			
1.5. Type of research 1.5.1. Institutional quality assurance			

1.5.2. Evaluation of public service program 1.5.3. Public health surveillance 1.5.4. Educational evaluation activities 1.5.5. Consumer acceptability test **These 5 have been identified in the NEGRIHP 2022 as exemptible, as long as it does not involve more than minimal risk.* **Please indicate in the Comments section the Item number found in SOP 07 for the specific type of research.*			
1.6. What is/are the method/s of data collection *(please tick appropriate box)* 1.6.1. Surveys and/or questionnaire, Interviews, or observations of public behavior 1.6.2. Audio/video recordings of public behavior 1.6.3. Research which only uses existing data **These have been identified in the NEGRIHP 2022 as exemptible, as long as anonymity and/or confidentiality is maintained.*			
1.7. Will the collected data be anonymized or de-identified?			
1.8. Is there a data protection plan? *Measures or guarantees to protect privacy and confidentiality of participant information and in compliance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 as indicated by data collection methods including data protection plans including the steps*			

to be taken so that all who have access to the data and the identities of the respondents can safeguard privacy and confidentiality (ex. providing adequate instructions to research assistants, transcribers, or translators) (NEGRIHP 2022); Plan on processing personal data, storage of data, access, disposal, and terms of use (NEGRIHP 2022; Data Privacy Act of 2012)			
1.9. Is this research likely to involve any foreseeable risk of harm or discomfort to participants; above the level experienced in everyday life? (NEGRIHP 2022) **Please refer to section 2. Risk Assessment, prior to answering this item* **If YES, then this protocol does not qualify for exemption*			
2. RISK ASSESSMENT	**YES**	**N/A**	
1.1. Does this research involve the following *(please select all that apply):*			
1.1.1. Any vulnerable groups?			
1.1.2. Highly Sensitive topics that may make participants feel uncomfortable *(i.e. sexual behaviour, illegal activities, racial biases, negative/traumatic experiences etc.)*			
1.1.3. Use of drugs			
1.1.4. Invasive procedure (e.g. blood sampling) and specify			
1.1.5. Physical stress/distress, discomfort			

1.1.6. Psychological/mental stress/distress (*i.e. negative/traumatic experiences*)			
1.1.7. Deception of/or withholding information from subjects			
1.1.8. Access to data by individuals or organizations other than the investigators			
1.1.9. Conflict of interest issues			
1.1.10. Or any other ethical dilemmas			
1.1.11. Is there any blood sampling involved in the study?			

RECOMMENDED ACTION:
_____ QUALIFIED FOR EXEMPTION
_____ NOT QUALIFIED FOR EXEMPTION

SUMMARY OF RECOMMENDATIONS:
1.
2.
3.

JUSTIFICATION FOR RECOMMENDED ACTION

PANEL CHAIR Signature _____

Date: <dd/mm/yyyy> Name <Title, Name, Surname>

**Form is adopted from UPMREB Form 2(L) 2019 Checklist for Exemption from Ethical Review*